PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Spin in the Neurosurgical trauma literature: prevalence and associated factors – a systematic review protocol
AUTHORS	Oliveira, João Vitor; Oliveira Júnior, André; Kolias, Angelos; Paiva, Wellingson; Fontoura Solla, Davi

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Belton, PAtrick University of Missouri-Columbia Medical School, Division of Neurosurgery
REVIEW RETURNED	03-Dec-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	Overall it is an interesting study proposal. The question has not been addressed in prior systematic reviews in this field. Specific corrections: Page 6, Line 86/87: "The inclusion of only randomized clinical trials may make our results more conservative and strength" Do you mean "and stronger"? Page 8, Line 134-138: "(((((Traumatic brain injury[Title/Abstract]) OR (TBI[Title/Abstract])) OR (Brain trauma[Title/Abstract])) OR (Brain concussion[Title/Abstract])) OR (Brain contusion[Title/Abstract])) OR (head trauma[Title/Abstract]) OR (head injury[Title/Abstract]) OR (brain injury[Title/Abstract]) will be used. The filters “Clinical trial” and “Randomized clinical trials” will be applied." This is an insufficient set of search terms and should likely be widened. Consider "traumatic subarachnoid", "subdural hematoma", "epidural hematoma", "traumatic intraparenchymal hemorrhage", etc. Medline/Pubmed does not accurately filter for study type, particularly in older papers, and this filter will likely exclude a large number of studies.

REVIEWER	Jellison, Sam Oklahoma State University Center for Health Sciences
REVIEW RETURNED	29-Jan-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	This study will be an important contribution to the literature Strengths and limitations: “… may make our results more conservative and strength.” Please rephrase this, this does not make sense. Maybe “May strengthen our results” will be sufficient. Risk of bias in individual studies This paragraph appears to be in past tense. This makes it seem like the study has already been performed. Please change this to

	future tense. Example: “the entire text of each included paper will be evaluated…”.

REVIEWER	Tisherman, Samuel A. University of Maryland School of Medicine
REVIEW RETURNED	24-May-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	General comments The authors have described their plan for a systematic review related to “spin” in the neurosurgical trauma literature. The protocol is reasonable and generally well described. This is a topic that has gained increasing interest and warrants more scholarly reviews like this. Specific comments A brief description of the definition of standardized difference and how it’s calculated would be helpful, rather than just the reference to Yang et al. Also, it seems that reference needs more detail. Regarding the impact of spin on specialty practice, it would be worthwhile to see if papers with spin are included as references for published clinical practice guidelines and whether or not guideline developers recognized the spin. Regarding the journals, what about the Journal of Trauma and Acute Care Surgery or Critical Care Medicine? This review covers papers over 60 years. Will there be an attempt to see if there have been changes over the years, particularly as journal editors have established more common guidelines for publication and conflicts of interest are more routinely (though not universally) disclosed and managed? Should studies that were stopped for futility or lack of funding be considered as a separate factor in the analysis? In the Risk of Bias in Individual Studies paragraph, the tense switches to the past, whereas the rest of the manuscript is in the future tense. Has the work already been done? If so, which parts?

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer 1
Comments: Page 6, Line 86/87: "The inclusion of only randomized clinical trials may make our results more conservative and strength" Do you mean "and stronger"?

Response: Dear reviewer, thank you for your careful review of our manuscript, your comments and questions helped us to improve the current version of our paper. Thank you for noticing that. We corrected the text as suggested by the reviewer 2.

Comments: Page 8, Line 134-138: "(((((Traumatic brain injury[Title/Abstract]) OR (TBI[Title/Abstract])) OR (Brain trauma[Title/Abstract])) OR (Brain concussion[Title/Abstract])) OR (Brain contusion[Title/Abstract])) OR (head trauma[Title/Abstract]) OR (head injury[Title/Abstract]) OR (brain injury[Title/Abstract]) will be used. The filters “Clinical trial” and “Randomized clinical trials” will be applied." This is an insufficient set of search terms and should likely be widened. Consider

"traumatic subarachnoid", "subdural hematoma", "epidural hematoma", "traumatic intraparenchymal hemorrhage", etc. Medline/Pubmed does not accurately filter for study type, particularly in older papers, and this filter will likely exclude a large number of studies.

Response: Thank for your suggestion, we added the new descriptors. About the filter, we do not found another way to do this search and even not being the best way, we accept to take the risk to loss a few papers

Reviewer 2
Comments: "… may make our results more conservative and strength." Please rephrase this, this does not make sense. Maybe "May strengthen our results" will be sufficient.

Response: Dear reviewer, thank you for your careful review of our manuscript, your comments and questions helped us to improve the current version of our paper. We made the change as suggested.

Comments: Risk of bias in individual studies
This paragraph appears to be in past tense. This makes it seem like the study has already been performed. Please change this to future tense. Example: "the entire text of each included paper will be evaluated…".

Response: Thank you for noticing that. We changed the text.

Reviewer 3
Comments: A brief description of the definition of standardized difference and how it's calculated would be helpful, rather than just the reference to Yang et al. Also, it seems that reference needs more detail.

Response: Dear reviewer, thank you for your careful review of our manuscript, your comments and questions helped us to improve the current version of our paper. We provided this explanation and checked the reference.

Comments: Regarding the impact of spin on specialty practice, it would be worthwhile to see if papers with spin are included as references for published clinical practice guidelines and whether guideline developers recognized the spin.

Response: As much as we found your suggestion very pertinent, we concluded this would fit better into a new other project of our group since it could misdirect our focus on this paper.

Comments: Regarding the journals, what about the Journal of Trauma and Acute Care Surgery or Critical Care Medicine?

Response: Thank you for the suggestion. We are going to include these journals in our data collection.

Comments: This review covers papers over 60 years. Will there be an attempt to see if there have been changes over the years, particularly as journal editors have established more common guidelines for publication and conflicts of interest are more routinely (though not universally) disclosed and managed?

Response: Yes, we are going to perform longitudinal analyzes. Thank you for the advice.

Comments: Should studies that were stopped for futility or lack of funding be considered as a separate factor in the analysis?
Response: Thank you for the suggestion. We are going to include this separate factor in the analysis.

Comments: In the Risk of Bias in Individual Studies paragraph, the tense switches to the past, whereas the rest of the manuscript is in the future tense. Has the work already been done? If so, which parts?

Response: We apologize for this. We corrected the text and rewrote it in future tense.

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Tisherman, Samuel A. University of Maryland School of Medicine
REVIEW RETURNED	18-Aug-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	The authors have responded well to the critiques